

A postcard of Swami Vivekananda posing in saffron robe and turban, produced in 1893 to publicise his participation in the Chicago Parliament of the World's Religions.

We are so many *sanyassin*s wandering about and teaching the people empty metaphysics. It is all madness. Did not our *Gurudeva* [his teacher Shri Ramakrishna] use to say 'An empty stomach is no good for religion'? That these poor people are leading the life of brutes is simply due to ignorance. We have for all ages been sucking their blood and trampling them under foot … We as a nation have lost our individuality, and that is the cause of all mischief in India. We have to give back to the nation its lost individuality and raise the masses.[10]